

***The Phillipian* Mobile App Project**

I. Introduction

The Phillipian's current digital presence consists primarily of our website, phillipian.net, and our Instagram account. While these do a good job placing our content onto the internet for broader access, there is room to further engage audiences using digital platforms to access our content. A mobile app would not only better user experience for phone users, where the current website can be difficult to use, but also provides additional benefits such as push notifications.

II. Key Features and Technical Considerations

Development: The app is developed using Javascript. In order to fetch the data (articles, images, etc) that is being displayed, it sends a request to the website (hosted by Wordpress), which sends back a JSON file (essentially a large amount of data) that is then directly populated on the app's page. There is no method of commenting on articles. In displaying the articles, it essentially mirrors the content on the website but presented in a mobile-friendly way.

Push notifications: Whether it be releasing Breaking News articles or running surveys like the State of the Academy or the mock election, push notifications allow for an easy way for the app to deliver timely news as well as increase engagement with surveys. Push notifications are only allowed on the app if, when installing, the user selects "Allow Notifications." They may also choose not to, in which case they will not receive any push notifications. This can be toggled at any time.

Privacy and data: Since *The Phillipian's* app would not require students to register or create an account, it does not ask for any data regarding the user. The app itself does not track nor record any user data. Instead, the only data tracked is that which Apple automatically collects for users on any of its apps. That is, app usage information including how often the app is used, the length of sessions, and user interactions within the app (which pages are visited), basic device information like type and operating system version, and performance metrics like how many instances of app crashes. Because *The Phillipian's* app does not have accounts or and does not use data collection services like Firebase or Google Analytics, no additional personal information, such as location or user identity, is collected.

III. Current Demo (screenshots)



